SHIVANI BALACHANDAR

Project Coordinator

Monterey, CA

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SKILLS

- Project Coordination, Cross-Functional Coordination, Agile/Scrum, Risk & Timeline Tracking, Stakeholder Communication, Python, C#, C++, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, SQL, CI/CD pipelines, Mechanics Design, Systems Design, Narrative Design, Prototyping, AI Integration, Usability Testing, Version Control, Marketing, Globalization

TOOLS

- Asana, Jira, Trello, Confluence, Smartsheets, Unity, Unreal, Microsoft Outlook, Excel, Word, Slack, Figma, Adobe Creative Suite (Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign, XD) Perforce, Google Drive, SDL Trados

LANGUAGES

English, French, Tamil, Korean, Japanese (limited working)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Alterea Inc. - **Game Production Intern** | June 2026 – August 2026 | Remote

• Served as Production Team liaison across the Legal & Operations teams and between Legal/Ops and executive leadership, coordinating information flow, priorities, questions, and follow-ups.
• Prepared weekly progress and process reports for an **11-member Legal & Operations meeting**, consolidating questions, updates, blockers, and operational concerns for discussion.
• Analyzed organizational workflows and identified **4 root operational gaps** affecting deadline tracking, work ownership, knowledge consolidation, and **Actual Plan** project tracker sustainability.
• Audited existing documentation and identified 12+ duplicate planning files, informing recommendations for improved taxonomy, naming conventions, version control, and knowledge sharing.
• Developed a Process Improvement Proposal, Cross-Team Coordination Framework, and Standardized Procedures covering project tracking, communication, ownership, escalation, documentation, and status reporting.

Indy Language Center- **Program Manager Assistant Intern** | June 2026 – August 2026 | Carmel, IN

• Led weekly coordination meetings with **3 program members**, preparing agendas, documenting decisions and action items, and following up on deliverables.
• Used **ClickUp** to organize projects, track tasks and deadlines, and improve visibility across ongoing program and marketing work.
• Led marketing operations and workflow development across content planning, website updates, and promotional initiatives, contributing to a $10K increase in July 2026 revenue compared with July 2025.
• Coordinated **website updating workflows and teacher-student communications** to support timely updates, information flow, and program operations.
• Prepared and analyzed **marketing and program analytics reports** to support stakeholder decision-making and identify opportunities for improvement.

Metamor Systems - **Project Coordinator** | May 2023 – Aug 2025 | Carmel, IN

• Supported Project Managers across technology projects by coordinating schedules, deliverables, documentation, meetings, communications, and follow-up activities.
• Automated employee incentivization calculations, reducing processing time by **90%** and achieving **0% error rate**.
• Coordinated cross-functional teams using **Jira, Smartsheets, Confluence, and Google Sheets**, improving sprint efficiency by **25%**.
• Designed reusable templates for **status reports, SOWs, and risk registers**, saving **10 hours/week** of manual work.
• Maintained version-controlled documentation to improve project visibility, traceability, and delivery predictability

PROJECTS

Eclipsed Truth Rattles in the Cup - **Game Developer and L10N Engineer** | Nov 2025 - Jan 2026 | Monterey, CA

- Developed game **solo in Unreal Engine using Blueprints**, owning gameplay systems, logic, and implementation end-to-end.
- Coordinated with 3p localization team using **Phrase TMS**; supported **LQA/DTP** workflows while managing tasks and bugs in **Jira**.
- Authored the **entire Game Design Document (GDD)** and all **English narrative content**, ensuring consistency across mechanics, story, and UX.
- Designed the game **localization-first**, conducting research for **Chinese, Japanese, and English** markets and implementing solutions for text expansion, UI flexibility, culturalization, and readability.
- Integrated localized text, UI assets, set dressing, music, and other game assets into Unreal Engine builds, validating in-engine functionality and presentation.
- Reduced downstream localization rework by proactively aligning narrative, UI, and technical constraints during initial design and implementation.

Bomb Buddies - **Lead Designer** | June 2022 – May 2023 | Los Angeles, CA

- Led 2–4 designers on a 30+ member team developing an AR cooperative party game for iOS.
- Coordinated design workflows through Codecks, standups, documentation, and cross-functional communication with engineering, audio, and UI/UX teams.
- Created and maintained GDDs, usability documentation, bug reports, and design specifications across multiple development milestones.
- Designed tutorial UI in Figma and Unity and developed 4 AR minigames through iterative prototyping and playtesting.
- Coordinated and analyzed 200+ playtests to identify usability and accessibility issues and inform design revisions.
- Adapted game scope and design systems in response to production constraints while maintaining accessibility as a core design pillar.

EDUCATION

MIDDLEBURY INSTITUTE OF INTERNATIONAL STUDIES AT MONTEREY (MIIS) | Monterey, CA
M.A. Translation & Localization Management | 2025 – Present

UNIVERSITY OF SOUTHERN CALIFORNIA (USC) | Los Angeles, CA
B.A. Interactive Media & Game Design | 2020 – 2023

COVER LETTER

I’m drawn to project coordination because I enjoy bringing people, ideas, and different perspectives together to make creative work happen. My path has taken me through game design, project coordination, and localization, but the common thread has always been my interest in how people work together to bring a project to life. I’m particularly interested in opportunities in game production and localization, where I can combine my creative background with my coordination and communication skills.

One of the things I value most in a team is understanding how different people approach a problem. In my coordination roles, I’ve enjoyed acting as a connection between teams, making sure information is shared, questions are addressed, and everyone has a clearer understanding of what needs to happen next. At Alterea, I worked between Legal, Operations, and executive leadership, identifying communication and workflow gaps and developing recommendations to improve project coordination. At Indy Language Center, I coordinated weekly team meetings and helped develop marketing workflows that contributed to a $10,000 year-over-year revenue increase.

I also enjoy approaching challenges from different angles and adapting when things change. At Metamor Systems, I developed reusable project templates that saved approximately 10 hours per week and helped automate incentive calculations, reducing processing time by 90%. My game development experience has given me another perspective on production: I’ve led designers on a team of over 30 people, coordinated with engineering, audio, and UI/UX, and independently developed a game in Unreal Engine while managing its localization and QA workflow.

I bring an empathetic, adaptable, and curious approach to teamwork, alongside a genuine interest in games and the experiences that connect players across languages and cultures. I would be excited to bring my combination of coordination experience, creative problem-solving, and game industry knowledge to a team developing games or localized content.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Shivani Balachandar